

FEATURE • NARRATIVE BUILD

Assemble the slide as you go.

A dense slide lands all at once. Walked live, the story is better told one beat at a time — a bullet, a table row, a line of code. `_build` makes that a one-line directive, derived from the slide's own structure, and it degrades to the whole slide in print.

The slide is the same. The reveal is the argument.

You don't split the content across slides — you sequence it in place. One grammar, a subset of `_focus`, addresses any surface: `item`, `row`, `col`, `line`. Document order is the order it builds.

`_build` — one step per point, in order.

- First you frame the problem.
- Then you show the evidence.
- Then you draw the conclusion.
- And only then the ask.

`_build: 1, 2-3, 4` — group beats into steps.

- The setup stands alone.
- These two land together —
- — because they're one idea in two halves.
- The payoff arrives last.

`_build: rows` — reveal the comparison row by row.

CRITERION	OPTION A	OPTION B	OPTION C
Speed	☒	☐	☒
Auditability	☐	☒	☒
Cost	Low	High	Low

`_build: lines` — walk the code a line at a time.

```
function reveal(step) {  
  const units = section.querySelectorAll('[data-build-step]');  
  for (const u of units) u.classList.toggle('lat-built', +u.dataset.buildStep <= step);  
}
```

Derived, restrained, print-faithful.

Beamer overlays, not PowerPoint.

The engine only tags the steppable units; the reveal is pure CSS. With no player driving it — and in every PDF — the slide simply shows whole. The live walk-through is the enhancement, never the artifact.